	Equipment Management		
	Document no: **7.4 Memo**		
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	Approved by:	**Nonhlanhla Msibi -** **Operations Manager**	

INTERNAL MEMORANDUM

To: All Laboratory Personnel

From: Sifiso Nyambi

Compiler: Sifiso Nyambi

Approved by: Nonhlanhla Msibi

Date: 13/04/2026

Subject: Control of Equipment Movement and Balance Stability (ISO/IEC 17025 Clauses 6.4 & 7.4)

1. Purpose

The purpose of this memorandum is to address the improper movement of the platform scale during sample preparation processes, which poses a significant risk to measurement accuracy and data integrity. This memo establishes strict controls in line with ISO/IEC 17025 requirements.

2. Scope

This instruction applies to all laboratory personnel involved in weighing, sample preparation, and handling of measuring equipment.

3. Requirement

In accordance with ISO/IEC 17025 Clause 6.4 (Equipment) and Clause 7.4 (Handling of Test Items), all weighing equipment, including balances and platform scales, shall remain in a fixed, controlled position during operation. No equipment shall be moved without prior authorization from laboratory management.

4. Instruction

Effective immediately (13-04-2025)

- No balance or platform scale is to be moved once calibrated and verified for use.

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- Any requirement to relocate equipment must be approved by laboratory management.
- Upon relocation, the equipment must undergo re-verification, leveling, and, where applicable, recalibration before use.
- Unauthorized movement of equipment will be treated as non-conformance.

5. Factors Affecting Balance Stability

The following environmental and operational factors significantly influence balance performance and measurement reliability:

- Air currents and drafts cause drift in readings.
- Temperature fluctuations affect internal components.
- Vibration from nearby equipment or foot traffic.
- Unstable or uneven surfaces affecting leveling.
- Electrostatic charges influence mass readings.
- Magnetic fields interfering with electronic balances.
- Improper leveling of the balance.
- Humidity variations affecting sample mass.
- Operator managing and inconsistent weighing techniques.

6. Compliance

Failure to comply with this instruction may result in invalid test results and compromise the laboratory's accreditation status. All personnel are required to adhere strictly to this directive.

7. Records

All equipment movement, maintenance, and verification activities must be documented in the equipment logbook in accordance with quality system procedures.

8. Revision History

Revision	Date	Description	Approved By
00	13-04-2025	Initial issue	Nonhlanhla Msibi

Revision	Initial Date	Next Rev Date
00	04/2026	04/2029

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